

Project guidelines

Work on the project and supervision

- You are in charge of managing and organizing the time of your project (do not wait for the last minute, after your last exam to advance on your project).
- You are in charge to keep your supervisor(s) informed of your progress, clear doubts with them, prompt meetings when necessary.
- Write elements with illustrations of your report as the work progresses. Do not let all the writing for the end. Some of this material may eventually be discarded, but it will speed up the production of the report.
- Backup your work regularly (on an external drive, pen drive, online or other).

Organization of the project defenses

- Project defenses will take place at the end of June (do not take holidays at this period).
- Attendance to project defenses is compulsory.
- The planning of the defenses will be sent later. It is set by the staff and agreed with the supervisors.
- All presentations of a session will use the same computer, provided by the staff, to avoid losing time. The computer will be running Ubuntu.
- You must use a PDF file for the presentation.
- Using a video in addition to the presentation is permitted. It should be on a pen drive. It is your responsibility to make sure it will run under Ubuntu. The video is not compulsory. It is intended to present results of experiments or simulations, and certainly not to include material you did not have time to put in your presentation file.
- Total duration of the presentation, including any video: 20 minutes sharp. The maximum duration will be strictly enforced: presentation will be stopped after 20 minutes, whether it is finished or not.
- The presentation will be followed by 5 to 10 minutes of questions

Submission of the report

- The report will be submitted one week before the defense. Your supervisor may require an earlier submission. The submission will be on <https://hippocampus.ec-nantes.fr>. A report submitted after the deadline, will have a penalty.
- Submission should consist of a single PDF file named according to the following format: «Report_name1_name2_2026.pdf».
- A model file for the front page is provided, in LibreOffice and Microsoft Office formats. If you use Latex, please do something with the same page organization and information, even if the fonts are not the exact same.

Other deliverables

- Depending on the nature of the project, your supervisor will probably define deliverables other than the report (typically software, data...) Check with your supervisor the nature and form of the additional deliverables. Those will be delivered directly to the supervisor.

Submission of the file for the presentation

- In order to be fair, all groups must submit their PDF file for the presentation one day before the defenses.
- The submission will be on <https://hippocampus.ec-nantes.fr>. A presentation submitted after the deadline, will have a penalty.
- Submission should consist of a single PDF file named after the group members, e.g « Presentation_name1_name2_2026.pdf ».

- You are strongly advised to upload at least a preliminary version early. Do not wait for the last minute. You can always submit a new version later, until the deadline.

Basic tips for the presentation

- Rehearse your presentation so you are sure to comply with the maximum duration. Do not use significantly less time, or it will look like you have done so little that you have very little to say.
- Number your slides, so the jury can easily reference a particular slide for a question.
- Do not put too much material on a slide.
- Make sure the characters are always large enough to be legible.
- Avoid fancy details and fancy slide transitions (not sure it's even possible with a PDF) that distract the audience: you need their full attention.
- Use short and simple sentences. Make an effort to pronounce clearly. Speak up: everybody in the room should be able to hear you.
- Do not read a text you have on paper.
- Do not put material that you have no intention to comment.
- Use additional slides for details useful to answer questions you anticipate may be asked.
- Balance the time of presentation between the group members (more or less).
- Avoid switching speaker too often.
- Do not speak long without visual (slide) support. You've got to be very good to do that...
- Rehearse the presentation in front of fellow students not involved in the project once it looks fine to you, and listen to their remarks. Then change roles by listening to their own presentation.
- Give a general introduction to your project before you dive into technical/scientific details.
- The supplied PC will run Linux Ubuntu. If you created your presentation under Windows, make sure it displays fine under Ubuntu (fonts,...). The Ubuntu PC will contain the so- called Windows Core Fonts (https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Core_fonts_for_the_Web).

Project evaluation

Project evaluation is based on three main items :

- Quality and amount of work produced (50%). This is mostly evaluated by your supervisors, but not only (other jury members, staff who read the report).
- Quality of the written report (25%). Evaluated by the supervisors and at least one more person.
- Quality of the oral presentation (25%). Evaluated by the jury members.